

Ideas about Family

Family size

- ☐ Families in many countries are not as large as they used to be
- ☐ We tend to live in small nuclear families rather than large extended families
- ☐ Parents tend to have fewer children
- ☐ Young children are no longer expected to work
- ☐ Nowadays both parents often work
- ☐ It costs so much to bring children up
- ☐ It is more difficult to raise a large family

Working Parents

- ☐ Children and their parents seem to be less close nowadays
- ☐ Parents spend less time with their children
- ☐ Women traditionally stayed at home to cook, clean and look after children
- ☐ Nowadays both parents often work full time
- ☐ Children may be left alone, or with nannies or babysitters
- ☐ Busy parents have less contact with their children
- ☐ Many families no longer eat meals together
- ☐ Children spend more time with friends or surfing the Internet

Negative Effects on Children

- ☐ The lack of closeness in families can have a negative effect on children
- ☐ Many parents have no idea how their children spend their time
- ☐ Friends, television and the Internet become the main influence on children's behavior
- ☐ Teenagers are influenced by peer pressure
- ☐ Some of them join gangs
- ☐ Juvenile delinquency is on the increase
- ☐ Parents should be more involved with their children's upbringing
- ☐ Young people need positive role models

Divorce

- ☐ In the past, divorce was unacceptable
- ☐ It was considered to be embarrassing for a family
- ☐ People stayed together for religious or family reasons
- ☐ Divorce is more socially acceptable nowadays
- ☐ It has become much more common
- ☐ Divorce can be extremely stressful
- ☐ Lone parents may face financial difficulties
- ☐ Many single parents have to rely on benefits paid by the state
- ☐ Divorce can have a negative effect on children
- ☐ Children from single-parent families are more likely to get lower grades or drop out of school.
- ☐ The rise in divorce rates may be connected to some social problems

Care for Old people

- ☐ Caring for elderly people was traditionally the responsibility of families
- ☐ Adults had to look after their elderly parents
- ☐ A woman's job was to stay at home taking care of her family
- ☐ Nowadays, fewer elderly people are looked after by their relatives
- ☐ Residential homes provide care for large number of elderly people
- ☐ Nursing homes can provide professional medical care
- ☐ Some families are unable to look after elderly relatives
- ☐ Families tend to be smaller these days, and women often have full-time jobs
- ☐ Care homes provide a professional service for senior citizens
- ☐ Nurses are better trained than family members

Care for Old People: Opinion

- ☐ The best form of care for the elderly depends on the family situation
- ☐ It depends on whether family members have the time resources
- ☐ We all have a responsibility towards the older people in our society
- ☐ Governments should invest money in facilities and training for care workers or social service workers